



ALPHA DATA

ALPHA DATA P.J.S.C

Higher Colleges of Technology

RFP Ref. NE-26-0129 — Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) — 3 Years

Managed Services

Proactive 24x7x365 Monitoring, Incident Resolution, Maintenance and PM Health Checks

Portal Section 3 — Item 2 (Evaluation Criterion 3.2, Weight 10%)

Technical Submission — September 2026

Commercial-in-Confidence

Alpha Data operates the SASE platform end-to-end for 3 years: 24x7x365 UAE-based monitoring and help desk, two SASE-certified Resident Engineers at HCT HQ with 100% backfill, quarterly preventive maintenance and configuration reviews, and an operating rhythm synchronised to HCT's academic calendar — all under the vendor performance scorecard with an >85% target.

1. Service Model Overview (Sections 3.11, 3.14)

Service Element	Commitment
Platform ownership	Full management of the SASE platform: health, availability, configuration, patching and security updates (3.11.18–3.11.19), with full local ownership at no additional cost to HCT (3.11.17)
Monitoring	24/7 proactive health, availability and performance monitoring with automated alerting; DEM-driven user-experience monitoring; MTTD target < 5 minutes
Help desk	24x7x365 help desk, single support contact number, published escalation matrix and support methodology (3.11.12)
On-site presence	2 x Resident Engineers (SASE certified) at HCT HQ during business hours, supporting all campuses — exceeding the SOW minimum of one; 100% backfill of each Resident Engineer during any absence at no cost to HCT; out-of-hours P1/P2 via help desk + OEM TAC (clarifications Q.8–Q.10)
Incident management	P1–P4 response/resolution per the Section 3.14.1 SLA matrix; HCT reclassification authority honoured with SLA clock reset (3.14.2.1); tickets closed only on HCT written confirmation (3.14.2.2); 3rd recurrence in 30 days auto-escalated to P1 with permanent-fix RCA (3.14.2.3)
Preventive maintenance	Quarterly PM, health checks and configuration reviews with findings, recommendations and implementation (3.11.16); quarterly configuration audit and clean-up per Section 3.18
Reporting & reviews	Monthly report (tickets raised/closed/breached with reasons, technology-wise detail, RCA for majors) + Excel ticket register + monthly review meeting (3.11.13–3.11.15); real-time SLA dashboard accessible to HCT 24x7 (3.14.5.1)
Governance	Monthly Operational Review, Quarterly Service Management Review, Bi-Annual Strategic Steering Committee, with vendor scorecard > 85% (3.21)

2. Academic-Calendar-Aware Operations (Section 3.11.29)

- Capacity surge plan: ≥150% of normal peak pre-provisioned at least 7 days before semester starts, examination periods, graduation and HCT-designated critical events.
- Change freezes: no maintenance, upgrades or policy changes from 3 business days before the first exam to 1 business day after the last, without explicit written HCT approval.
- Staffing surge: one additional senior engineer on standby through examination and registration weeks.
- Pre-semester readiness review ≥14 days before each semester start: platform health, capacity validation, certificate expiry review, integration validation, and zero pending changes/known issues.
- End-user communication protocol for planned works aligned to HCT's notification standards.

3. Proactive Operations and AIOps

- AI-driven root-cause analysis correlating user-experience degradation with network path, PoP performance or policy conflicts — shrinking mean time to resolve.
- Predictive capacity management forecasting traffic and PoP utilisation ahead of academic peaks.
- Synthetic monitoring of HCT's critical SaaS destinations (LMS, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace) with alerting on degradation before users report it.
- IOC scanning of security logs with a prioritised compromised-host list surfaced to HCT's SOC.
- Configuration drift detection with automated alerts to both Alpha Data operations and HCT IT, and remediation of unauthorised drift within 4 hours (3.18.2.2).

4. Maintenance, Patching and Lifecycle

- Timely patch management and security updates with immediate fault remediation (3.11.19), tested first in the sandbox tenant, scheduled outside freeze windows.
- Automated daily configuration backups, 365-day retention, restore to any prior state within 2 hours for P1 (3.18.2.3); annual restore drills evidenced to HCT.
- Quarterly configuration audit: unused-policy identification (90-day no-match), orphaned-object clean-up, baseline comparison and immutable change-audit logs (3.18.1–3.18.2).
- CMDB register of all platform components, policy objects, integrations and group mappings, updated within 5 business days of change (3.13.5).

5. Service Level Commitments (Accepted in Full)

Alpha Data accepts the complete SLA regime — availability (99.999% platform; 99.999% SWG/FWaaS; 99.9% RBI launch and console; DEM freshness <5 min; 99.99% ZTNA), the incident response/resolution matrix, the escalation matrix through to Regional Director engagement, independently verifiable measurement, the narrow exclusions list, security-efficacy SLAs and the associated financial remedies. The formal statement of acceptance is provided in submission S3.5.

6. Training and Knowledge Transfer (Section 3.12)

- OEM training for a minimum of 4 HCT IT administrators (training mandatory; per HCT clarification Q.12).
- 90-day structured knowledge-transfer programme with practical assessment as a handover gate (3.17.6).
- Annual refresher training for the contract duration at no additional cost, covering new features and best practices (3.12.5).
- Dedicated sandbox tenant available throughout the term for HCT administrator training and policy testing (3.16.10).

7. Vendor Performance Scorecard (Section 3.21.1)

KPI	Target	Our Method
MTTD	< 5 minutes	SIEM correlation + platform alerting

KPI	Target	Our Method
MTTR	Per SLA matrix	ITSM analytics, monthly evidence
False positive rate	< 0.1%	Quarterly sampling and tuning
Threat detection rate	> 99%	AMTSO/AV-TEST benchmarked engines
Change success rate	> 99%	Sandbox-first change pipeline, tested rollback
Config drift incidents	< 2 / quarter	Automated drift detection + 4-hour remediation
User experience (DEM)	> 85 / 100	Continuous DEM scoring + proactive tuning
On-time reporting & training	100%	Governance calendar with named owners